Root Cause Team

AI For Financial Literacy

The Role of AI in ASEAN Social Impact

BorNEO HackWknd 2026

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1.0 Introduction

1.1 Background of Case Study

The ASEAN region has experienced significant growth in digital financial services over the past decade. Mobile banking, digital wallets, cashless payments, and Buy Now Pay Later (BNPL) services have become increasingly integrated into everyday transactions. These platforms offer convenience, speed, and broader financial access, especially among young adults and urban populations.

At the same time, financial technology is becoming more sophisticated, with systems capable of analyzing spending behavior and generating data-driven insights. Artificial Intelligence (AI) is now being integrated into financial platforms to provide automated recommendations, spending analysis, and personalized financial guidance.

Given this evolving digital financial landscape, there is growing interest in exploring how AI-powered interfaces can be designed to support users in navigating modern financial tools more effectively. This project focuses on developing a prototype that demonstrates how AI can be applied to enhance user interaction with digital financial services in ASEAN.

1.2 Chosen SDG

The Sustainable Development Goal (SDG) that has been chosen for this case study is **SDG 4: Quality Education** and **SDG 8: Decent Work and Economic Growth**. SDG 4 focuses on ensuring inclusive and equitable quality education and promoting lifelong learning opportunities for all. In the context of this project, financial literacy is an important form of practical education that helps individuals to understand financial concepts.

Other than that, SDG 8 focuses on promoting inclusive and sustainable economic growth, employment, and financial stability. Improving financial literacy and access to financial services can help individuals, especially students and entrepreneurs to manage their finances better and strengthen economic resilience in ASEAN countries.

1.3 Problem Statement

Despite the rapid growth of digital financial services in ASEAN, many individuals lack sufficient financial literacy to manage these tools effectively. Users often adopt digital wallets and other financial technologies without fully understanding financial risks, interest rates, or long-term financial consequences. As a result, people may have easy access to tools for spending but limited knowledge about saving, budgeting, and financial protection.

This lack of financial knowledge can lead to poor financial decisions and financial insecurity. Furthermore, limited understanding of financial services prevents many people from accessing insurance, investment, and other financial protection systems that can improve their financial situations. Therefore, there is a need for innovative solutions that can help improve financial literacy and financial decision-making among individuals in the region.

1.4 Objectives

The objectives of this project are:

1. To design an AI-driven interface that translates complex financial data into personalized, actionable budgeting advice for users.
2. To visualize how AI-based financial tools can assist users in understanding financial concepts such as savings, debt management, and financial planning.
3. To present a user-friendly digital solution that helps individuals in ASEAN better manage their finances and improve financial resilience.

2.0 Review of Existing Solutions

Various digital financial management tools and financial literacy platforms have been developed to help users manage their finances more effectively. These solutions generally focus on budgeting, expense tracking, and providing financial insights to improve financial decision making.

One of the well known budgeting applications is Mint, which allows users to connect their bank accounts, track spending, categorize expenses, and monitor financial activities in real time. Mint provides users with visual summaries such as charts and spending breakdowns to help them understand their financial habits. However, the application mainly focuses on financial tracking and does not strongly emphasize financial education or personalized financial literacy guidance for new users.

Another popular financial management platform is YNAB (You Need A Budget), which is designed to help users plan their budgets in advance and allocate their income into specific spending categories. YNAB encourages proactive budgeting and financial discipline by helping users assign every dollar to a specific purpose. Although the system is effective for budgeting, it may require users to already have a basic understanding of financial planning concepts, which can be challenging for beginners.

Similarly, PocketGuard provides users with insights into how much money they can safely spend after accounting for bills, savings, and necessities. The application simplifies expense monitoring and helps prevent overspending. Despite its useful budgeting features, the platform focuses more on financial tracking rather than improving financial literacy through educational content.

While these existing solutions offer valuable financial management tools, several limitations remain. Many platforms primarily emphasize expense tracking and budgeting but provide limited educational resources to help users understand financial concepts such as debt management, interest rates, or financial risks related to services like Buy Now, Pay Later (BNPL). In addition, these applications often lack personalized financial guidance tailored specifically for different user groups such as students or small entrepreneurs.

Therefore, there is a need for a more integrated solution that not only tracks financial activity but also improves users' financial knowledge and decision-making skills. The proposed TrackWise application aims to address these gaps by combining budgeting tools, AI driven financial advice, and structured financial education through its AI Financial Coach and Learning Hub features.

3.0 Methodology

3.1 Design Approach

The TrackWise application applies the Human-Centered Design (HCD) approach to assure that the proposed mobile application addresses the real financial literacy challenges faced by students and entrepreneurs directly. This approach aims to understand user needs and designing solutions that are practical, accessible, and easy to use.

The development process was structured into four related key phases which are problem identification, solution ideation, prototyping, and evaluation. These structured phases are important to make sure that the application remains user-focused and aligned with the financial literacy gaps identified in the case study, especially in understanding the digital financial tools such as Buy Now, Pay Later (BNPL) services.

By highlighting the accessibility and usability of the proposed mobile application, TrackWise, the methodology ensures that it functions not only as a budget tracking tool but can be also used as an educational platform that encourages responsible financial behaviour. The application integrates financial tracking, AI-based guidance, and financial learning resources to assist users making informed financial decisions.

3.2 Problem Definition

Based on the analysis of the case study and current trends in digital financial services within ASEAN, several key issues were discovered during the analysis. Despite swift and steady growth in digital payments, understanding or literacy in finance remains relatively low. Most users lack sufficient knowledge of BNPL (Buy Now, Pay Later) mechanisms, interest calculations, debt management, and financial threat protection.

Students usually encounter difficulty managing their monthly allowances and spending, especially digitally, while entrepreneurs struggle with efficient cash flow monitoring and how to separate personal and business finances. These gaps and problems lead to the increase of debt accumulation risk and poor financial decision making.

Thus, this TrackWise project aims to develop a mobile budget tracking application that is integrated with an AI Coach and Learning Hub to refine awareness in finance, promote responsible usage of digital finance, and strengthen financial resilience among targeted users.

3.3 Ideation and Feature Planning

Following the identification of common financial literacy challenges, potential solutions were conceptualized to address these issues directly. The ideation process focused on designing the features that combine both financial tracking together with educational support.

The first and main feature of TrackWise is a Budget Tracker that allows users to fill in, arrange, and observe their expenses. Users can have a better understanding on how their financial behavior is and identify overspending patterns through visual dashboards and summarizing spending.

The second feature includes the AI Financial Coach that provides personalized financial insights and recommendations based on the user input and their spending habits. The AI Coach can answer user questions, provide financial recommendations, and assist users in understanding their financial situation.

The third feature of the TrackWise application is the Learning Hub, which lays out the structured educational content covering vast key topics such as BNPL mechanisms, interest calculation, debt risks, basic insurance awareness, and emergency fund planning. The feature is designed to be as simple as possible while still being interactive to ensure accessibility for both students and entrepreneurs.

Additionally, the application includes two user modes, which are Student Mode that focuses on allowance management and savings planning, and Entrepreneur Mode which emphasizes more on cash flow tracking and financial organization for small businesses.

For student users, extra features were added such as Savings Fund that enables users to set savings goals while tracking their progress to achieve the target, and BNPL tracker to monitor their Buy Now, Pay Later transactions and view outstanding payments.

As for entrepreneurs users, additional features such as Business Insights and Investment Planning are also included. The Business Insights dashboard provides financial summaries and performance indicators that help to monitor their business performance, while the Investment Plan feature helps them to track financial growth and plan future investments.

3.4 Prototyping

A low to mid-fidelity prototype of the TrackWise mobile application was developed using Figma to visualize system flow and feature interaction. The prototype includes several main interfaces such as the welcome screen, registration pages, savings fund dashboard, BNPL tracker, budget tracker, AI financial coach interface, learning hub modules, business insights dashboard, and investment planning screen.

The user journey begins with the registration process, where users create an account and provide basic information such as financial goals and income details. Users then select their profile type as either a student or entrepreneur. After completing the setup process, users can access the main dashboard where they can track expenses, monitor savings goals, review BNPL commitments, and receive financial insights from the AI Financial Coach.

The interface design highlights clarity, simplicity, and easy navigation between interfaces to encourage users' constant engagement.

3.5 Prototype Evaluation

Since the TrackWise system was developed as a prototype using Figma, evaluation was conducted at the conceptual level to review the usability and clarity of the interface design. The prototype was reviewed by several users who explored the interface and navigated through different features such as the budget tracker, savings dashboard, AI coach interface, and learning hub modules.

Participants were asked to observe the application flow and provide feedback regarding the clarity of the interface, ease of navigation, and usefulness of the proposed

features. The input provided highlighted areas where interface components could be adjusted and where the explanations of financial concepts could be enhanced.

The evaluation focused on confirming that the prototype design accurately conveys the desired financial functionalities and aids users in better comprehending their financial actions.

3.6 Ethical Considerations

Ethical deliberations were implemented throughout the development process. No sensitive financial data was collected during testing, and all feedback received was used solely for academic purposes.

Moreover, the AI Financial Coach aims to offer informative financial guidance instead of professional financial advice. The conceptual design emphasizes user privacy and responsible AI utilization to assure that the TrackWise application assist financial literacy while safeguarding user trust and data security.

4.0 Results

The results of this project demonstrate the successful development of a functional prototype that illustrates how Artificial Intelligence (AI) can enhance financial literacy and financial management for different user groups. Using Figma, we designed two tailored interface flows: one for students and one for entrepreneurs, each addressing their specific financial needs.

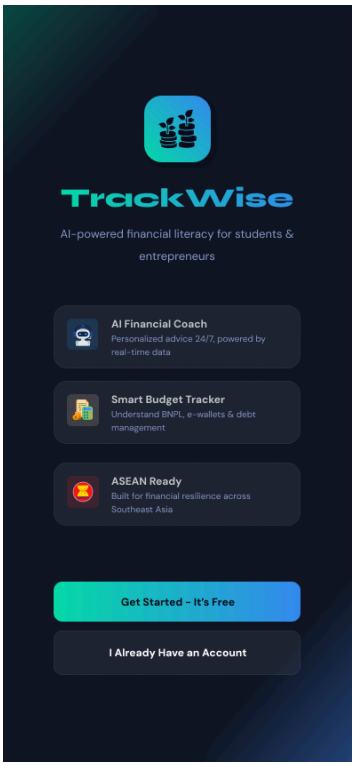
First, the prototype successfully achieved the objective of designing an AI-driven interface that translates complex financial data into personalized and actionable budgeting advice. The prototype demonstrates how financial tools such as the Budget Tracker and Saving Funds features help users visualize their spending patterns, allowing them to better understand where their money goes and how they can improve their budgeting habits.

Second, the prototype effectively visualizes how AI-based financial tools can assist users in understanding key financial concepts, including savings, debt management, and financial planning. Through clear interface designs and simplified data presentation, the prototype shows how users could receive guidance and insights using the AI Financial Coach feature. This helps fill the gap between complex financial systems and everyday users who may not have strong financial knowledge.

Finally, the project presents a user-friendly digital solution aimed at helping individuals in ASEAN like students and entrepreneurs manage their finances and build financial resilience. The interface design emphasizes accessibility, clarity, and ease of use so that users can interact with the system comfortably. Overall, the results indicate that the proposed prototype is capable of demonstrating how AI-driven financial tools can improve financial literacy and support more informed financial behavior among users in the region.

5.0 Prototype Showcase

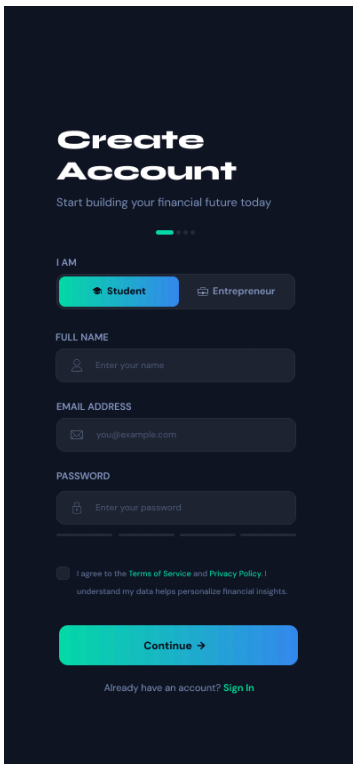
Figma was used as a medium to demonstrate the functionality and user flow of the proposed TrackWise. The following screenshots illustrate the main user interfaces and highlight the key features of the mobile application.



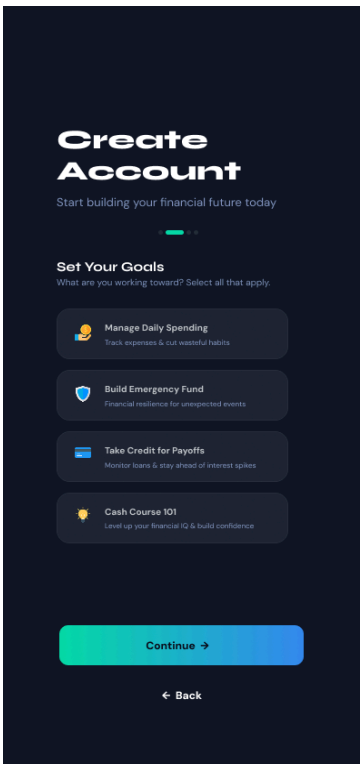
Welcome screen displaying the TrackWise features and options to sign up or log in as an existed user

5.1 Student

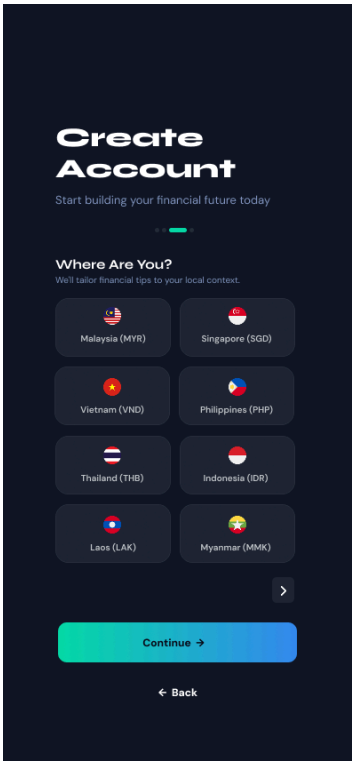
5.1.1 Sign up page



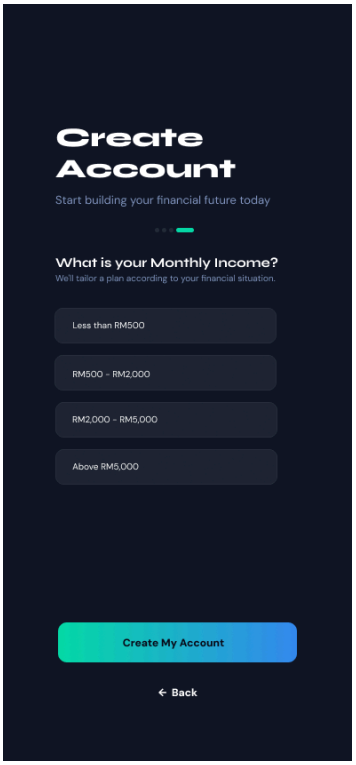
Registration page where users fill in required details to create a new TrackWise account



Account creation screen allowing users to set up their goals

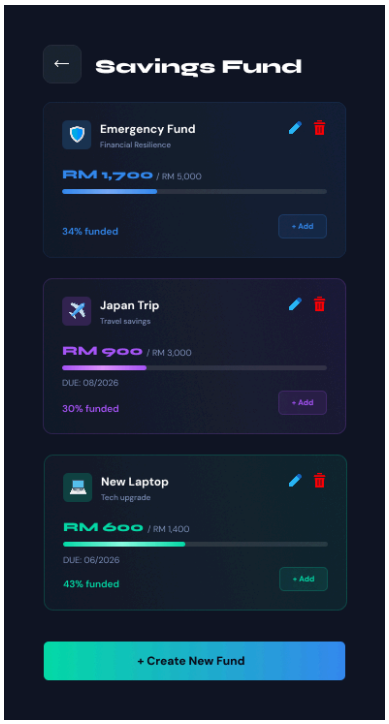


Continuation of creation page to select their country of origin



Creation page which ends with question on their monthly income

5.1.2 Saving Funds

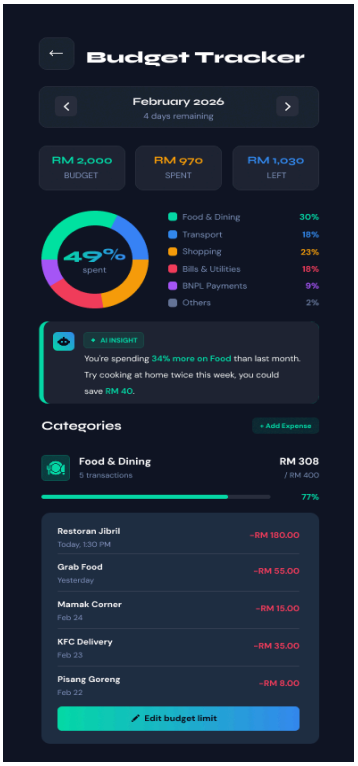


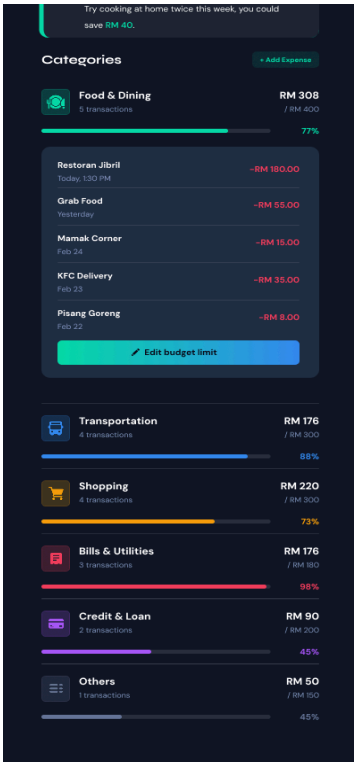
Savings fund dashboard displaying different savings goals and allowing users to track their progress toward financial targets

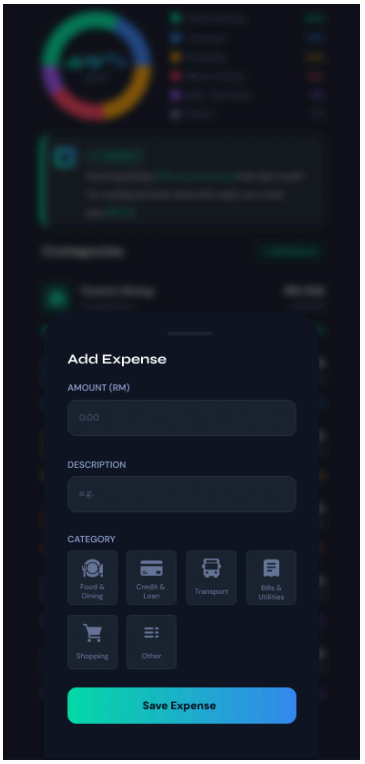
5.1.3 BNPL Tracker

BNPL Tracker interface that monitors Buy Now Pay Later transactions while providing an AI Tips on financial advices

5.1.4 Budget Tracker feature





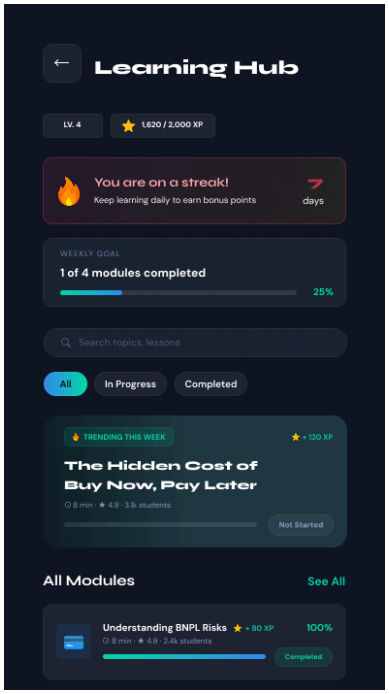


Budget Tracker dashboard showing spending categories, expense distribution, and tools for recording and managing daily expenses.

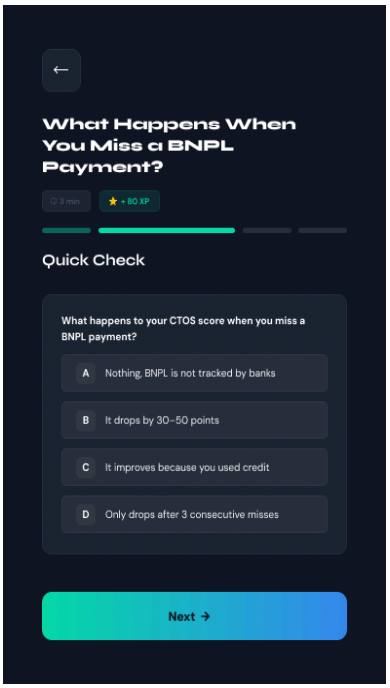
5.1.5 AI Financial Coach feature

AI Financial Coach chat interface providing personalized financial advice and insights based on user spending behavior. It is also ready to assist by answering any questions given to it

5.1.6 Learning Hub feature



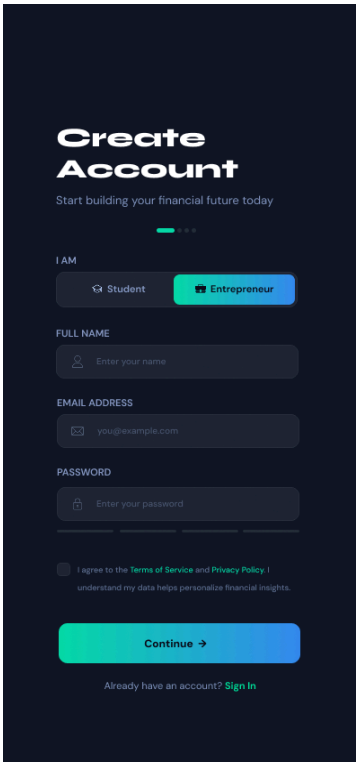
Learning Hub interface displaying educational financial modules, progress tracking, and interactive learning resources



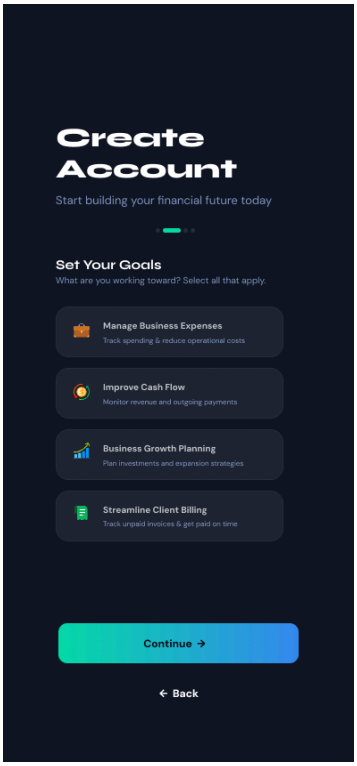
Each learning module screen presents financial education content and interactive quizzes to enhance financial literacy

5.2 Entrepreneur

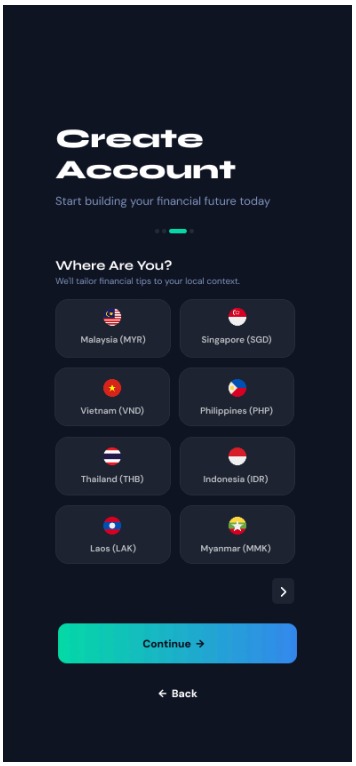
5.2.1 Sign up page



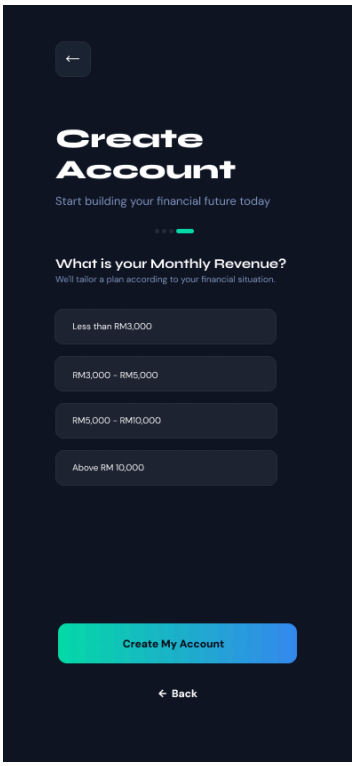
Registration page where users fill in required details to create a new TrackWise account



Account creation screen allowing users to set up their entrepreneur goals

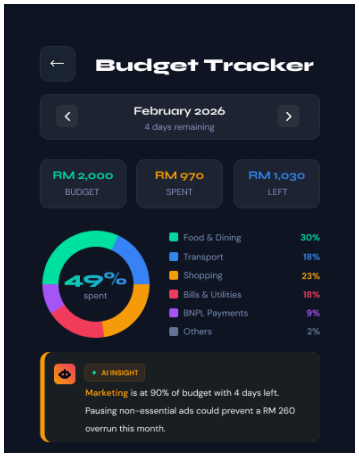


Continuation of creation page to select their country of origin



Creation page which ends with question on their monthly revenue

5.2.2 Budget Tracker feature

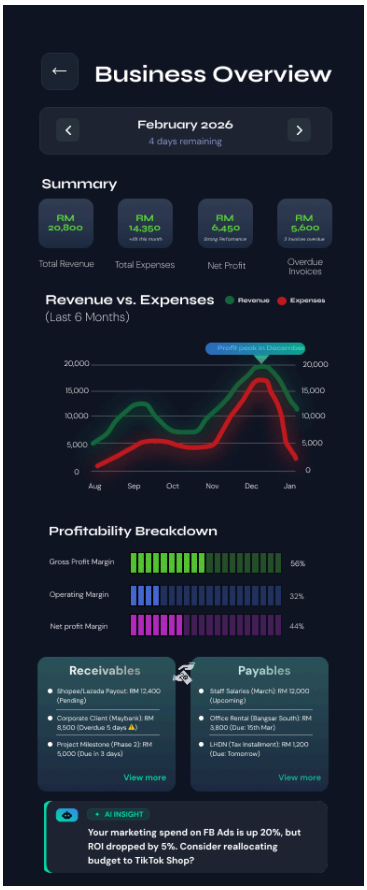


Budget tracking interface for entrepreneurs displaying expense categories and financial summaries for business spending

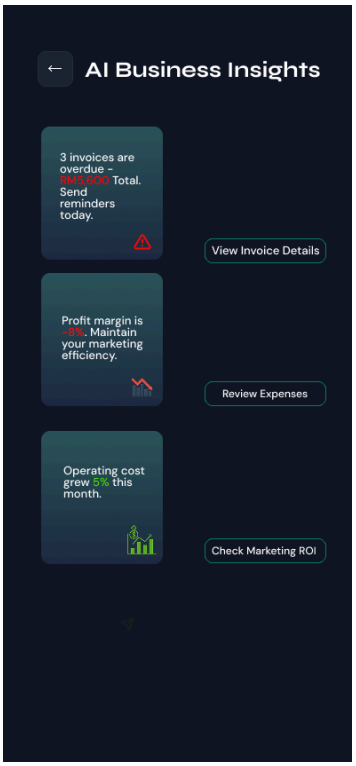
5.2.3 AI Financial Coach feature

AI Financial Coach interface displaying automated financial summaries that analyze and present the current performance of the business

5.2.4 Business Insight feature



Business overview dashboard presenting financial summaries, revenue trends, and performance indicators



AI Business Insights interface analyzing business performance

5.2.5 Investment Plan

Investment planning dashboard displaying portfolio performance, financial growth indicators, and goals allocation insights

5.3 Examples for both Student and Entrepreneur

Dashboard for Student with progresses and financial score

Dashboard for Entrepreneurs with overviews and business score

6.0 AI Acknowledgement

Artificial Intelligence tools were used during the development and documentation of the TrackWise project.

Claude was used during the early design phase to generate references and ideas for the initial user interface (UI) concepts of the TrackWise mobile application. These references helped the team explore possible layouts and feature organization before developing the prototype in Figma.

ChatGPT was used to assist with language refinement, organization of written explanations, and improvement of the clarity and structure of the report. It helped with grammar correction, sentence restructuring, and formatting of certain sections to improve readability.

All project ideas, system design decisions, prototype development, and final report content were reviewed and validated by the project team members. The AI tools were used only as supportive tools to assist the development process and did not replace the team's own work and analysis.

7.0 Conclusion

In summary, although digital financial services in the ASEAN region continue to expand rapidly, financial literacy and resilience remain significant challenges, especially students and young entrepreneurs who lack access to personalised tools and the knowledge needed to manage them effectively.

The proposed solution, Trackwise addresses this gap by delivering tailored, AI-driven financial management tools designed around the distinct needs of both user groups. For students, the application offers features such as budget tracking, savings fund tracking, an AI chatbot and a learning hub to support financial education and encourage responsible saving habits. For entrepreneurs, Trackwise provides budget tracking, invoice tracking, a business overview dashboard and an AI-powered guidance to support daily financial decision-making.

By integrating practical financial management tools with AI assistance and educational resources, TrackWise aims to improve financial awareness among its users. The application serves as a digital financial companion that supports users in developing better financial habits, strengthening their financial knowledge, and building long-term financial confidence.